Spotlight, Eurovision

Slide 1, title

Every May millions of people watch the votes come in and say the same thing: they only vote for their neighbours. We built something that tells you how much of that is true.

Slide 2, Greece to Cyprus

Since 2016 Cyprus has made it to the final eight times. Every single time, the Greek public gave it twelve points. Maybe Cyprus just sent good songs. Maybe Greeks simply like Cyprus. As a fan you can't tell the two apart. The people who send the songs can't either.

Slide 3, juries and public

It gets more confusing because every country votes twice, once with a jury and once with the public. The two often tell different stories. Israel in 2024 got 52 points from the juries and 323 from the public. Switzerland in 2025 got 214 from the juries and nothing at all from the public.

Slide 4, song or neighbours

So we went through every vote in the ten finals since 2016 and split it into two parts. One part is the song, measured by how well it did with everybody else. The other part is the neighbours, so how close two countries are and how they voted for each other before. To make sure this is not luck, we always checked the numbers on finals our method had not seen. The song explains a quarter of a jury vote and forty percent of a public vote. The neighbours explain three percent for the juries. For the public they explain twelve. So the neighbours count four times as much for the public.

Slide 5, look up your country

All of this is on our website. You pick a year and a country and see who it gave points to, juries and public side by side. Here is Greece in 2024, with Cyprus on top again. Switch to Got and you see who gave points to your country instead. Below that you see who your country really favours over all ten finals and who favours it.

Slide 6, who it is for

For fans this puts real numbers on the oldest argument of the contest. For delegations it shows which part of a result they can change with the song and its promotion and which part they cannot, because it comes from neighbours and diaspora. Juries and the public also react differently, so the same entry can need a different plan for each. Try it with your own country at tim.kicker.dev/projects/esc-research.